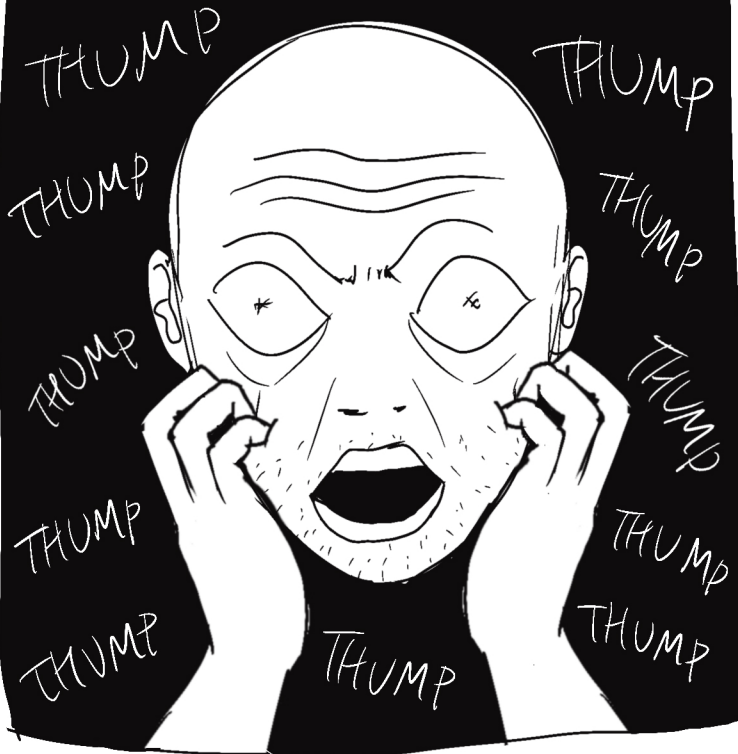
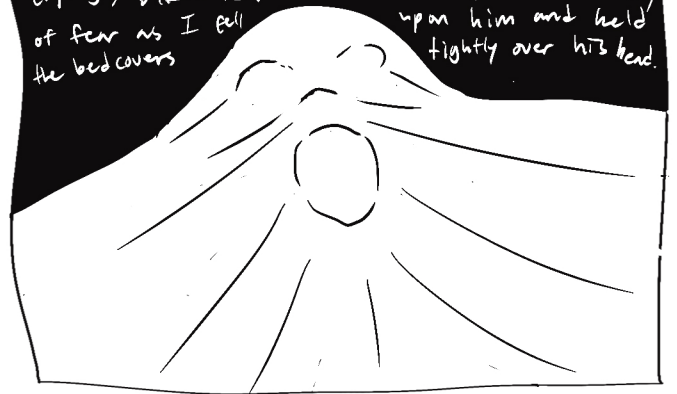


It was the beating of the old man's heart. I tried to stand quietly. But as the sound grew louder my anger became greater and more painful.



The time had come! I rushed into the room, crying, "DIE DIE!" The old man gave a loud cry of fear as I fell upon him and held the bed covers tightly over his head.



The old man was dead. I took away the bed covers and held over his heart. There was no sound. Yes. He was dead! Dead as a stone.



His eye would trouble me no more.

So I am mad, you say? You should have seen how careful I was to put the body where no one could find it.



First I cut off the head, then the arms and the legs.

I was careful not to let a single drop of blood fall on the floor.



I pulled up three of the boards that formed the floor, and put the pieces of the body there.



Then I put the boards down again, carefully, so carefully that no human eye could see that they had been removed.

As I finished my work I heard that someone was at the door. I had no fear.



However, as I went to open the door. Three men were at the door, three officers of the police. One of the neighbours had heard the old man's cry and had called the police; these three had come to ask questions and to search the house.